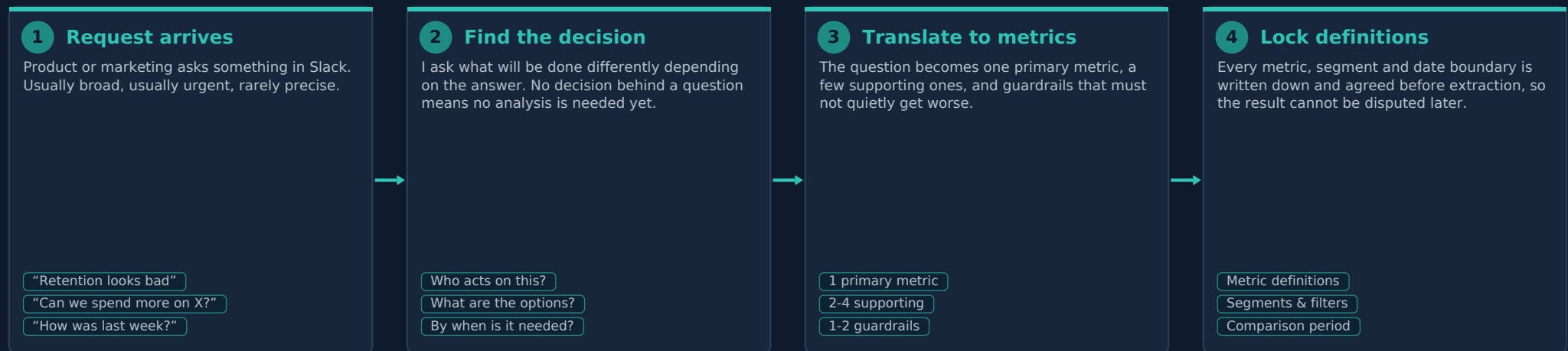


Goals & Metrics — turning a request into a question data can answer

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Step 1 of the weekly workflow: before a single query is written, the question, the KPI set and the comparison period are fixed in writing



Reframing — the part that makes the difference between a report and an answer

Asked as

"Retention is down, fix it"

"Should we spend more on channel X?"

"Send me last week's numbers"

"This affiliate looks great"

What I ask back

Down for which cohort, on which product, against which baseline? Did a bonus campaign end?

What is the budget decision, and what CAC would still be acceptable at current LTV?

Which decision is this feeding? A weekly report and an investigation are different deliverables.

Great on volume or on value? Are we counting registrations, or players who deposited and stayed?

Question we actually answer

Did D7 retention fall for players registered last week on mobile casino, versus the previous two weeks, excluding the promo cohort?

At current spend, does channel X reach payback within 90 days, and how does its FTD quality compare with the other paid channels?

Standing weekly view: GGR, actives, deposits and retention week over week, with anything outside the expected range flagged for follow-up.

For traffic from this partner, what is the FTD rate, average first deposit and D30 retention, compared with the affiliate portfolio average?

Output of this step — a short written brief everyone signs off on

Question Decision it feeds Primary metric Supporting metrics Guardrails Segments Comparison period Exclusions Owner Deadline

One page, agreed in writing before extraction begins — it is the reference every later number is checked against.

Definitions — where iGaming metrics quietly disagree

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Most reporting disputes are not calculation errors: two teams simply used two different definitions. These are the ones I pin down first

Definitions agreed before extraction

- **Active player**

Logged in, placed a bet, or deposited? Each gives a different number. I use bet activity and state it on the dashboard.

- **New player**

Registration or first deposit (FTD)? Marketing usually means registrations, finance means FTDs. Both are reported, never mixed.

- **GGR vs NGR**

GGR is stakes minus wins. NGR deducts bonuses, jackpot contribution, chargebacks and fees — the number the business actually keeps.

- **Retention D7**

Exactly on day 7, or any activity within 7 days? Classic and rolling retention differ by several points and are never compared to each other.

- **ARPU vs ARPPU**

Same numerator, different denominator: all actives vs paying players only. Mixing them up makes a healthy month look flat.

- **Cohort anchor**

Cohorts by registration date answer acquisition questions; cohorts by FTD date answer monetisation questions. The anchor is chosen per question.

- **Day boundary**

A gaming day rarely ends at midnight UTC. Timezone and cut-off are fixed once, or daily numbers never reconcile with finance.

- **Currency**

Multi-currency deposits converted at a documented daily rate, with the original value kept alongside for audit.

- **Bonus money**

Is a bonus-funded bet a real bet? It counts for engagement, but is stripped out of revenue — otherwise promo weeks look artificially strong.

- **Churn**

No activity for 30 days, or a formal account closure? For casino I use an inactivity window and state its length explicitly.

- **Deposit vs net deposit**

Deposits alone flatter the picture. Deposits minus withdrawals is what actually funds the balance.

- **Test and internal accounts**

The exclusion list is agreed once and applied everywhere, so QA and staff activity never reaches a business number.

Choosing the comparison period

- **Week over week**

Default for the weekly review. Same weekdays only — a 6-day week against a 7-day week is a reporting bug, not a trend.

- **Same week last month / year**

Used when seasonality dominates: sports calendar, holidays, paydays and salary cycles in the main geos.

- **Against the promo calendar**

Any period containing a bonus campaign is compared against a comparable promo period, never against a quiet week.

- **Rolling 28 days**

For volatile products, smooths weekday noise while still reacting faster than a monthly view.

- **Cohort age, not calendar date**

Retention is compared at equal cohort age — a 3-day-old cohort against a 30-day-old one says nothing.

- **Stated, not assumed**

The baseline is written in the brief. Changing it later without saying so is the fastest way to lose trust in a dashboard.

Scope control — what I deliberately leave out

- **One question, one primary metric**

A brief with six 'primary' metrics is an unfinished conversation, not a spec.

- **Guardrails instead of extra reports**

Rather than analysing everything, I name 1-2 metrics that must not silently degrade while we optimise the primary one.

- **Nice-to-have goes on a list**

Side questions are logged for a later cycle instead of quietly expanding this week's scope.

- **No metric without an owner**

If nobody in the business owns a number, nobody will act on it — it does not belong on the dashboard.

- **Vanity metrics stay out**

Registrations without deposits, impressions without clicks: they fill a slide and drive no decision.

- **Known limits stated up front**

If tracking gaps or a missing partner report will limit the answer, that is said before the work starts, not after.